

Workflow



Control

You

Cost



Complexity



DEFINITION

You define the path. The LLM is one step in it.

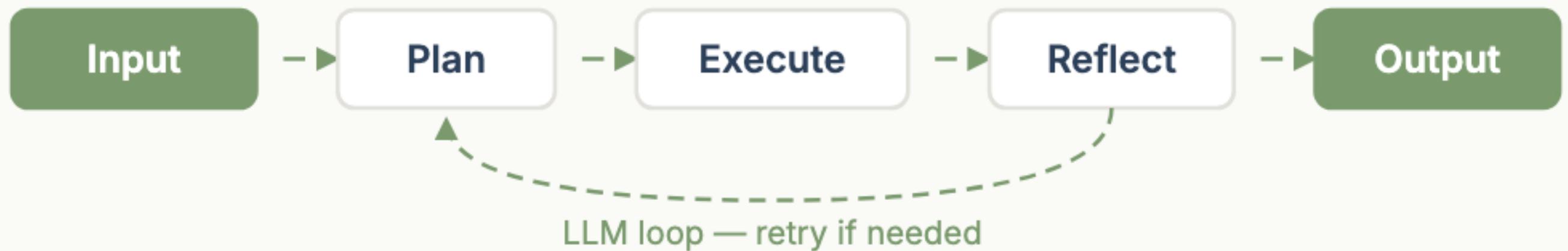
BENEFITS

- ✓ Same cost every time you run it
- ✓ You can trace exactly what happened
- ✓ Full control over every step

LIMITATIONS

- Struggles with ambiguous tasks
- You have to map every path upfront

Agentic Workflow



Control

You + LLM

Cost



Complexity



DEFINITION

You define the structure. The LLM decides when to retry.

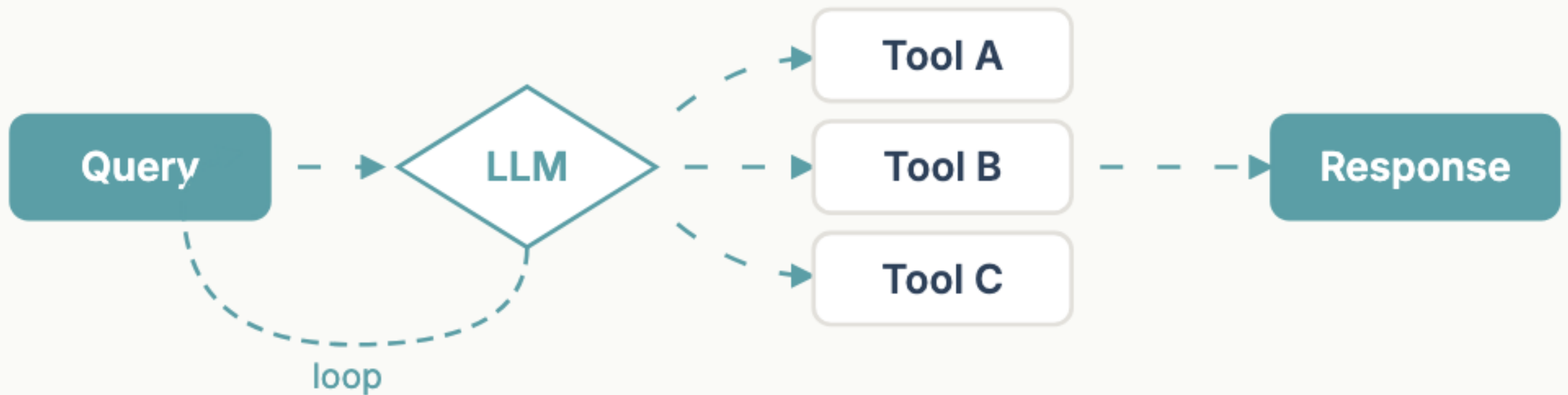
BENEFITS

- ✓ AI makes decisions inside guardrails
- ✓ Can retry and self-correct
- ✓ Structure with room to adapt

LIMITATIONS

- Loops need careful bounds
- Harder to reason about

Agent



Control

Cost

Complexity

Model



DEFINITION

You give it tools and a system prompt. The LLM decides which tool to use.

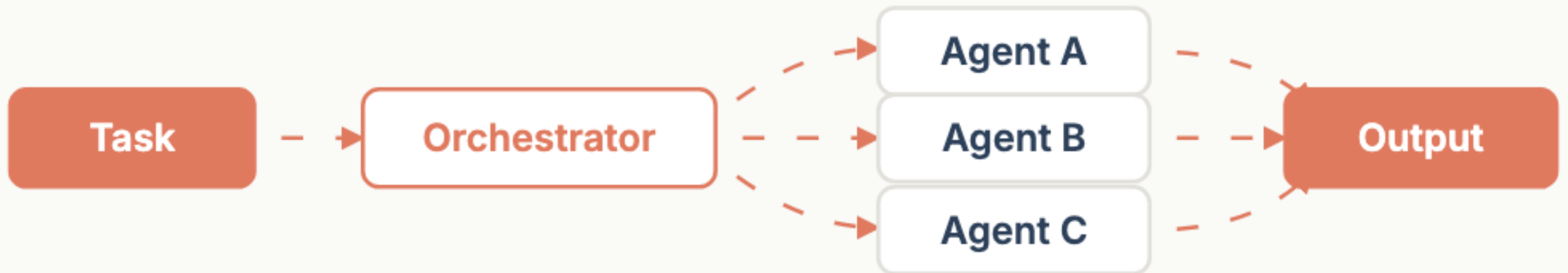
BENEFITS

- ✓ Figures out the path on its own
- ✓ Adapts when things change
- ✓ Quick to build a first version

LIMITATIONS

- More steps means more room for error
- Token costs are hard to predict

Multi-Agent



Control

Cost

Complexity

Models

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DEFINITION

Multiple agents, each with their own prompt and tools.

BENEFITS

- ✓ Conflicting roles get their own agent
- ✓ Parallel deep work across domains
- ✓ Scales like a team

LIMITATIONS

- Token costs multiply fast
- Hardest to debug when something breaks